

Friday, 26 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 38° 24°	BIRMINGHAM Rain 34° 22°	MANCHESTER Rain 34° 21°	GLASGOW Rain 27° 18°
-------------------------------	-------------------------------	-------------------------------	----------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The UK is set for its hottest June night on record, after temperatures soared to an incredible 36.4C yesterday.

Yeovilton in Somerset broke Wednesday's record for the hottest June day, as the country continues to bake in a heatwave. Forecasters say temperatures will remain high overnight, making it uncomfortable for many.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

A teenager has been cleared of murdering a nine-year-old girl, following a trial at Bristol Crown Court.

The 16-year-old was found not guilty of both murder and manslaughter. The verdict brings to an end a high-profile case that has gripped the nation.

CRIME · UK
- 3

The boss of Nottingham University Hospitals NHS Trust says she is 'shocked and upset' by findings from a major maternity review.

The review highlighted significant failures within the trust's maternity services. Steps will now be taken to address the issues raised and improve patient care.

HEALTH · UK
- 4

One person has died and a child is critically injured after a train collided with a car at a level crossing in Houghton.

An eight-year-old girl is currently in hospital with life-threatening injuries. Emergency services were quickly on the scene following the incident.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 5

The government plans to introduce jail time and unlimited fines for those found guilty of conversion practices.

A new Bill aims to protect LGBT people from 'abusive acts' designed to change their identity. This move follows years of campaigning from various groups.

LEGISLATION · UK

What's coming up

1 **Hollywood director Quentin Tarantino and pop icon Kylie Minogue have been spotted filming a new drama in Wales.**

They're joined by Wu-Tang Clan's RZA for the mystery project. It sounds like a star-studded affair and a big boost for Welsh filmmaking.

ON AIR – What kind of film do you think this unlikely trio could be making together?

FILM · COMING SOON

2 **Fans of 'The Other Bennet Sister' will be thrilled to hear a Christmas special is on its way!**

Filming for the new three-part special is set to resume in Wales this summer. It's a lovely festive treat to look forward to later in the year.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of period dramas, and what makes a good Christmas special for you?

TV · CHRISTMAS

3 **A new BBC six-part drama, 'Hamburg Days', will chronicle The Beatles' early years.**

The series will chart the band's growth from their beginnings in Hamburg. It promises to be a fascinating look at the legendary group's formation.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Beatles era, and which band member's story would you most want to see explored?

TV · COMING SOON

4 **Get ready for the highly anticipated 'Grand Theft Auto 6' – but it comes with a hefty price tag and no physical disc!**

The game is set to cost £70, and physical copies will only contain a code for a digital download. It's a sign of the times for the gaming world.

ON AIR – Are you happy to pay more for new video games, and does not getting a physical disc bother you?

GAMING · COMING SOON

5 **The prestigious TV Festival is set to move from Edinburgh to Manchester next year.**

The event, a key date in the television industry calendar, is relocating to 'radically' cut costs. It's a big change for the festival's long-standing tradition.

ON AIR – Do you think moving big events like this to different cities is a good idea for spreading opportunities?

TV · NEXT YEAR

On the schedule

1 **Emma Raducanu has missed Wimbledon practice amid injury concerns, after her strong run to the Queen's final.**

She's managing an injury aggravated during her recent tournament success. Fans will be hoping she's fit and ready for the start of Wimbledon.

ON AIR – How do you think Emma Raducanu will perform at Wimbledon this year, and what are your hopes for her?
TENNIS · UK

2 **This weekend's Austrian Grand Prix has been declared a 'heat-hazard race' by Formula 1's governing body, the FIA.**

The decision comes as a heatwave sweeps across Europe, raising concerns for driver safety and car performance. It's going to be a challenging race for everyone involved.

ON AIR – What impact do you think extreme heat has on Formula 1 races, both for the drivers and the cars?
F1 · THIS WEEK

3 **New Zealand captain Tom Latham has hit a 'fabulous' century against England on day one of the third Test at Trent Bridge.**

Latham's impressive performance has put New Zealand in a strong position. England will be looking to fight back on day two.

ON AIR – Are you following the Test Match, and what's your favourite aspect of Test cricket?
CRICKET · UK

4 **Scotland's World Cup hopes are in peril after a 3-0 defeat by Brazil in Miami, following calamitous defending.**

The loss means Scotland's chances of reaching the knockout stages for the first time are now in significant doubt. The Tartan Army will be anxiously awaiting other results.

ON AIR – After that result, do you think Scotland can still make it through to the knockout stages, or is it too big an ask?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Defender Piero Hincapie has completed his permanent £34.5m move to Arsenal from Bayer Leverkusen.**

The Ecuadorian international's loan spell has now been made permanent, strengthening Arsenal's defence. It's a significant signing for the Gunners.

ON AIR – What do you make of Arsenal's transfer business this summer, and who else do you think they need?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A charming new trend sees people embracing the simple joy of 'letter writing' once more.**
Moving beyond quick emails and texts, many are finding satisfaction in crafting thoughtful, handwritten messages to friends and family. It's a lovely way to slow down and connect.
- 2 The humble 'picnic' is being rediscovered as a delightful way to enjoy the great outdoors.**
Forget fancy dining; packing up a blanket and some tasty sandwiches for an al fresco meal in a local park or beauty spot is proving to be a popular pastime for all ages.
- 3 A recent study suggests that listening to 'podcasts' while doing chores can make household tasks feel much less like a burden.**
Whether it's a gripping story or a fascinating discussion, popping on an audio treat can transform vacuuming or washing up into an enjoyable, productive activity.
- 4 More Brits are finding serenity in the art of 'cloud watching', turning sky-gazing into a mindful moment.**
Taking a few minutes to simply observe the ever-changing formations above can be a surprisingly calming and imaginative break from daily routines.
- 5 The enduring appeal of 'vintage vinyl records' continues to spin, with sales seeing a resurgence among music lovers.**
There's something special about the tactile experience of putting on a record, and the warm, rich sound is a joy for many.
- 6 Experts are highlighting the benefits of a 'digital detox', encouraging short breaks from screens for better well-being.**
Even just an hour away from phones and computers can help to clear the mind and encourage more present-moment enjoyment of life.
- 7 A new appreciation for 'local markets' is blossoming, with more people seeking out fresh, artisan produce.**
It's not just about supporting local businesses; it's about the vibrant atmosphere and the chance to discover unique, delicious items you won't find in big supermarkets.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our houseplants, even though we know they can't really understand us?

ANSWER: TALKING TO THEM! APPARENTLY, A LITTLE CHAT WITH A FERN IS QUITE COMMON.

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'food' that we absolutely have to have with a cup of tea. What is it?

ANSWER: A BISCUIT! OF COURSE, NOTHING BEATS A GOOD BREW AND A BICCIE.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you hear a 'jingle' or a 'catchphrase' from an old advert, and it instantly gets stuck in your head for the rest of the day?
What's that one advertising slogan or tune from years ago that still pops into your mind and you just can't shake?
- We all have those 'little things' that we collect, don't we? Maybe it's not a grand collection, but just a small gathering of items that bring you joy.
What's something you quietly collect at home, even if it's just a specific type of mug or an interesting stone from the beach?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos are naturally born with grey feathers, and their iconic pink colour comes from the beta-carotene in their diet of brine shrimp and algae?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you whisper a secret to a sunflower, it will turn its head slightly towards the sun to keep your secret safe from prying ears.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£9.52 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£9.52 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first successful passenger railway opened in Stockton and Darlington in 1825.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The inventor of the Pringles can, Fredric Baur, was buried in one.
- The only letter that doesn't appear in the name of any US state is the letter 'Q'.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- The shortest complete English sentence is 'I am'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as three-dimensional wallpaper.

On this day

Day 177 of the year, 188 days left in 2026. Today Day of the Armed Forces of Azerbaijan; Christian feast day: Anthelm of Belley; Christian feast day: David the Dendrite; Christian feast day: Blessed Giacinto Longhin. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1993 — Ariana Grande, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1992 — Jennette McCurdy, American actress and singer-songwriter
- 1975 — Terry Skiverton, English footballer and manager
- 1984 — Aubrey Plaza, American actress
- 1970 — Sean Hayes, American actor
- 1909 — Colonel Tom Parker, Dutch-American talent manager, manager and promoter of Elvis Presley (died 1997)
- 1990 — Iman Shumpert, American basketball player
- 1955 — Mick Jones, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — The former British Protectorate of British Somaliland gains its independence as Somaliland.
- 2007 — Pope Benedict XVI reinstates the traditional laws of papal election in which a successful candidate must receive two-thirds of the votes.
- 1997 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules that the Communications Decency Act violates the First Amendment to the United States Constitution.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2007 — Pope Benedict XVI reinstates the traditional laws of papal election in which a successful candidate must receive two-thirds of the votes.
- 1988 — The first crash of an Airbus A320 occurs when Air France Flight 296Q crashes at Mulhouse–Habsheim Airfield in Habsheim, France, during an air show, killing three of the 136 people on board.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — Julian Assange, founder of WikiLeaks, returns to Australia after pleading guilty to one charge of espionage in a Saipan court and subsequently being released by the United States Department of Justice.

- 2000 — The Human Genome Project announces the completion of a "rough draft" sequence.
- 2015 — The U.S. Supreme Court rules, 5–4, that same-sex couples have a constitutional right to marriage under the 14th Amendment to the United States Constitution.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 178 of the year, 187 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Arialdo; Christian feast day: Crescens, one of the Seventy disciples; Christian feast day: Cyril of Alexandria (Coptic Church, Roman Catholic Church, Anglican Communion and Lutheran Church); Christian feast day: Hemma of Gurk. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Matthew Lewis, English actor
- 1936 — Shirley Anne Field, English actress (died 2023)
- 1924 — Bob Appleyard, English cricketer and businessman (died 2015)
- 1974 — Christian Kane, American singer-songwriter and actor
- 1975 — Tobey Maguire, American actor
- 1959 — Lorrie Morgan, American singer
- 1960 — Jeremy Swift, English actor
- 1942 — Danny Schechter, American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2015)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1995 — Space Shuttle Atlantis launches on STS-71, the first space shuttle mission to dock with the Russian space station Mir.
- 1977 — France grants independence to Djibouti.
- 2024 — U.S. President Joe Biden debates former U.S. President Donald Trump. Biden's perceived poor performance leads to his withdrawal from the election on July 21.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — Villa Tunari massacre: Bolivian anti-narcotics police kill nine to 12 and injure over a hundred protesting coca-growing peasants.
- 1954 — The Obninsk Nuclear Power Plant, the Soviet Union's first nuclear power station, opens in Obninsk, near Moscow.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)